CouriersPlease

Domestic Shipment Create

API Documentation

Version Control

Version	Date	Notes	Author
1.0.0	15/06/2016	Initial version.	Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease)
1.0.1	7/07/2016	Suburb and postcode validation.	Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease)
1.0.2	11/10/2016	Updated URL's.	Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease)
1.0.3	26/10/2016	Fixed URL's.	Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease)
1.0.4	18/04/2017	Added ATL logic.	Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease)
1.0.5	27/10/2017	Added Optional POPPoint Pickup Added Optional POPPoint Delivery Added Optional Ready date time	Kalpesh Pandya (CouriersPlease)
1.0.6	11/12/2018	Physical and volume weight restriction changes	Kalpesh Pandya (CouriersPlease)
1.0.7	22/04/2025	Document Update	Silvio Mueller (CouriersPlease)

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Overview

This document defines the API in which E-Merchants can create a consignment for a domestic shipment. The consignment number returned is then passed as a parameter in the Domestic Label API to retrieve a PDF version of the labels. This version of the Create Shipment API does not support customised connote number ranges or the use of SSCC barcodes.

Format

Request	JSON	
Response	JSON	XML Response Discontinued 2024
HTTP Method	POST	
Authorization	BASIC	Combination of account number and API Key

URLs

Sandbox

While developing and testing use the sandbox URL:

https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/shipment/create

Production

After deploying to live use the production URL:

https://api.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/shipment/create

Security

API Access

API security is controlled by CouriersPlease. CouriersPlease controls the following:

1. Access to Sandbox environment.
2. Access to Production environment.
3. Access to each individual API.
4. Hourly/Daily/Monthly limits.

If you require security changes then please contact CouriersPlease API support:

Email apisupport@couriersplease.com.au or connect@couriersplease.com.au

Authentication

API Validation is performed through HTTP Basic Authentication using the CouriersPlease Account Number and Authorization Token.

Username: CouriersPlease Account Number

Password: Sandbox or Production Token provided from the CouriersPlease API Developer Portal

When using HTTP Basic Authentication, the Username and Password must be Base64 encoded in the header.

If your CouriersPlease Account Number is W99999 and your token is ABC123456789 your Authentication Header would be “Authorization: Basic W99999:ABC123456789” before encoding it. Once encoded, it should look as follows: “Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ==”

Sample request header using CURL

```
curl \
--location 'https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/shipment/create’\
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--header 'Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ=' \
--data '{}’
```

Encryption

The API Endpoints and Portal are encrypted using SSL as follows:

SSL Attribute	**SSL Detail**
Signature Hash Algorithm	sha256
Public Key	RSA (2048 Bits)

API Request

This section contains the parameters and examples of a Domestic Shipment Create API request

Parameters

Name	Mandatory/Optional	Type	Content
pickupDeliveryChoiceID	**Optional**	**String**	ID of Collection Point where consignment will be dropped off for pickup by Couriers Please. Use the DeliveryChoiceID obtained from the Delivery Choices API. NOTE: If a value is entered in this field the pickup address information will be overridden with Collection Point details. (See Note 1)
pickupFirstName	**Mandatory**	**String**	First Name of Sender. Only letters and hyphens allowed. (See note 2) Max Length: 50
pickupLastName	**Mandatory**	**String**	Last Name of Sender. Only letters and hyphens allowed. Max Length: 50
pickupCompanyName	**Optional**	**String**	Sender Company Name. Max Length: 50 Enter a value in this field if the pickup location is a business.
pickupEmail	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid email address.
pickupAddress1	**Optional**	**String**	Pickup Address Line 1. Required if pickupDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 100
pickupAddress1	**Optional**	**String**	Pickup Address Line 2. Max Length: 100
pickupSuburb	**Optional**	**String**	Valid Australian Suburb. (See note 3) Required if pickupDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 100
pickupState	**Optional**	**String**	Valid Australian State Code (e.g: NSW). Required if pickupDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 3
pickupPostcode	**Optional**	**Integer**	Valid Australian Postcode. Required if pickupDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 4
pickupPhone	**Optional**	**String**	Valid phone number Max Length: 20 Only numbers, spaces and the + symbol are allowed.
pickupIsBusiness	**Mandatory**	**String**	Address Line 1 Max Length: 19

destinationDeliveryChoiceID	**Mandatory**	**String**	ID of Collection Point where consignment will be delivered, by CP, for pickup by the receiver. Use the DeliveryChoiceID obtained from the Delivery Choices API. NOTE: If a value is entered in this field the Delivery address information will be overridden with Collection Point details. (See Note 1)
destinationFirstName	**Mandatory**	**String**	First Name of Receiver. Only letters and hyphens allowed. Max Length: 50
destinationLastName	**Mandatory**	**Integer**	Last Name of Receiver. Only letters and hyphens allowed. Max Length: 50
destinationCompanyName	**Optional**	**String**	Receiver Company Name. Max Length: 50 Enter a value in this field if the pickup location is a business.
destinationEmail	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid email address.
destinationAddress1	**Optional**	**String**	Receiver Address Line 1. Required if destinationDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 100
destinationAddress2	**Optional**	**String**	Receiver Address Line 2. Max Length: 100
destinationSuburb	**Optional**	**String**	Valid Australian Suburb. Required if destinationDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 100
destinationState	**Optional**	**String**	Valid Australian State Code (e.g: NSW). Required if destinationDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 3
destinationPostcode	**Optional**	**Integer**	Valid Australian Postcode. Required if destinationDeliveryChoiceID is null Max Length: 4
destinationPhone	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid phone number Max Length: 20 Only numbers, spaces and the + symbol are allowed.
destinationIsBusiness	**Mandatory**	**Boolean**	"True" or "False"
contactFirstName	**Mandatory**	**String**	Contact First Name. Only letters and hyphens allowed. Max Length: 50. (See note 3)
contactLastName	**Mandatory**	**String**	Contact Last Name. Only letters and hyphens allowed. Max Length: 50.

contactCompanyName	**Optional**	**String**	Contact Company Name. Required if contactIsBusiness = true. Max Length: 50.
contactEmail	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid email address.
contactAddress1	**Mandatory**	**String**	Contact Address Line 1. Max Length: 100
contactAddress2	**Mandatory**	**String**	Contact Address Line 2. Max Length: 100
contactSuburb	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid Australian Suburb. Max Length: 100
contactState	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid Australian State Code (e.g: NSW). Max Length: 3
contactPostcode	**Mandatory**	**Integer**	Valid Australian Postcode. Max Length: 4
contactPhone	**Mandatory**	**String**	Valid phone number. Max Length: 20 Only numbers, spaces and the + symbol are allowed.
contactIsBusiness	**Mandatory**	**Boolean**	"True" or "False"
specialInstruction	**Optional**	**String**	Delivery Instructions will appear on label. Max Length 140
referenceNumber	**Optional**	**String**	Reference Number will appear on label Max Length: 40
termsAccepted	**Mandatory**	**Boolean**	"True" or "False" Terms must be accepted to create a shipment. See notes for link to Terms and Conditions.
dangerousGoods	**Mandatory**	**Boolean**	"True" or "False" Value must be "False" to create a shipment. See notes for link to Dangerous Goods Info.
rateCardId	**Mandatory**	**String**	Enter the RateCardCode obtained from the Domestic Quote API.
isATL	**Mandatory**	**Boolean**	"True" or "False" Enter "False" if a Signature is required.
readyDateTime	**Optional**	**Date/Time**	**Not to be used when multiple consignments are being picked up from a single address.** Format: yyyy-MM-dd hh:mm tt Eg: 2025-04-03 01:30 PM or 2025-04-25 07:30 AM Date cannot be more than 3 days in the future (see note 4).
items	**Mandatory**	**Object**	At least one item object describing the items is required
quantity	**Mandatory**	**Integer**	1 to 10. Maximum 10 items
length	**Mandatory**	**Integer**	Whole number in cm. Range 1-180

			(see note 5)
width	Mandatory	Integer	Whole number in cm. Range 1-180 (see note54)
height	**Mandatory**	**Integer**	Whole number in cm. Range 1-180 (see note 5)
physicalWeight	**Mandatory**	**Decimal**	2 decimal places in Kg. Range 0.01 to 25.00

Note 1: Use the Delivery Options API to find a participating collection Point where customers can drop off or collect their parcels. Populate this field with the Drop Location ID. Example: use 4515 for "droplocation_id": 4515.

Note 2: The first name and last name pertains to a contact at the pickup location. Example: John Smith. If there is no specific contact then populate both fields with the word "store", "Warehouse" or something similar that indicates where the freight should be picked up from.

Note 3: In most cases the contact details are the same as the sender details. Aggregators and Third-Party Shippers should populate their details in the contact fields.

Note 4: The franchisee will be advised of the pickup request at the date/time passed in the request. The pickup will occur after this time. Do not populate this field if more than one consignment will be picked up from the same address. Use the Book Pickup API instead.

Note 5: There is an oversize surcharge for dimensions exceeding 105cm. Maximum volume per item is 0.16 cubic meters.

Note 6: Use the “Locations” API to obtain a valid suburb and/or postcode. Alternatively, a Location Master file can be downloaded from the Couriers Please website under the “Resources” menu at https://www.couriersplease.com.au/

Note 7: Terms and conditions can be found on the Couriers Please website at https://www.couriersplease.com.au

Sample Request HTTP

Below is a sample request that returns JSON. The HTTP Request Header must contain application (example: “Accept: application/json”). The username and password are Base64 encoded in the authorization header as specified in the Authentication section of this document.

Request

POST https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/ v1/domestic/shipment/create HTTP/1.1

Request Header

Host: api-test.couriersplease.com.au Accept: application/json
Content-Type: application/json
Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ== Content-Length: 462

Request Body


```
{
  "items": [
    {
      "length": 10,
      "width": 10,
      "height": 10,
      "physicalWeight": 6,
      "quantity": 1
    }
  ],
  "specialInstruction": "Leave at door",
  "termsAccepted": true,
  "dangerousGoods": false,
  "rateCardId": "L55",
  "pickupDeliveryChoiceID": null,
  "pickupFirstName": "Kathy",
  "pickupLastName": "Lee",
  "pickupCompanyName": null,
  "pickupEmail": "test@couriersplease.com.au",
  "pickupAddress1": "Unit 2, Test Street",
  "pickupAddress2": null,
  "pickupSuburb": "Southport",
  "pickupState": "QLD",
  "pickupPostcode": "4215",
  "pickupPhone": "0123456789",
  "pickupIsBusiness": false,
  "destinationDeliveryChoiceID": null,
  "destinationFirstName": "John",
  "destinationLastName": "Doe",
  "destinationCompanyName": "CouriersPlease",
  "destinationEmail": "test@couriersplease.com.au",
  "destinationAddress1": "C/- CouriersPlease",
  "destinationAddress2": "2-20 McDonalds Lane",
  "destinationSuburb": "Mulgrave",
  "destinationState": "VIC",
  "destinationPostcode": "3170",
  "destinationPhone": "1300 361 000",
  "destinationIsBusiness": true,
  "contactFirstName": "Couriers",
  "contactLastName": "Please",
  "contactCompanyName": "CouriersPlease",
  "contactEmail": "test@couriersplease.com.au",
  "contactAddress1": "133 Foundation Road",
  "contactAddress2": null,
  "contactSuburb": "Truganina",
  "contactState": "VIC",
```

```
  "contactPostcode": "3029",
  "contactPhone": "1300 361 000",
  "contactIsBusiness": true,
  "readyDateTime": null,
  "isSignatureRequired": false,
  "referenceNumber": "318726",
  "isATL": false
}
```


API Response

Each request will return both an HTTP Status Code and a Response Code, which can be used to understand if the request was successfully processed. The response code will be in JSON.

API Response Codes

Code	Response
200	Success
401	Authentication failed
403	Requesting server IP address is blocked
404	No data found
429	Number of allowable requests exceeded
500	Error in process or service unavailable

Check the trouble shooting guide at the end of this document for more information on error responses.

API Response Object

A successful API response, where HTTPS Status Code = 200 and Response Code = SUCCESS, will return an object with field names as follows:

Name	Type	Content
consignmentCode	String	Consignment Number of the new consignment created.
referenceNumber	String	Consignment Reference number
jobNumber	Integer	If readyDateTime is not null then it will provide Booking number, otherwise, it will be null
PICKUP	Object	
firstName	String	Pickup First name
lastName	String	Pickup Last Name
companyName	String	Pickup Company Name
email	String	Email Address
deliveryChoiceID	Integer	If Pickup from POPPoint (pickupDeliveryChoiceID is not null)
address1	String	Pickup Address Line 1
address2	String	Pickup Address Line 2
suburb	String	Pickup Suburb
state	String	Pickup State
postcode	Integer	Pickup Postcode
phone	String	Pickup Phone Number
isBusiness	Boolean	True/False
DESTINATION	Object	
firstName	String	Destination First name
lastName	String	Destination Last Name
companyName	String	Destination Company Name
email	String	If Delivery to POPPoint (destinationDeliveryChoiceID is not null)
deliveryChoiceID	Integer	Email Address
address1	String	If Delivery to POPPoint then null else Destination Address Line 1
address2	String	If Delivery to POPPoint then null else Destination Address Line 2
suburb	String	If Delivery to POPPoint then null else Destination Suburb
state	String	If Delivery to POPPoint then null else Destination State
postcode	Integer	If Delivery to POPPoint then null else Destination Postcode
phone	String	Destination Phone Number
isBusiness	Boolean	True/False

Sample Response (200 - Success)


```
{
  "responseCode": "SUCCESS",
  "msg": "",
  "data": {
    "consignmentCode": "CPWL55900117228",
    "referenceNumber": "318727",
    "jobNumber": null,
    "pickup": {
      "firstName": "Sender",
      "lastName": "Test",
      "companyName": null,
      "email": "unknown@couriersplease.com.au",
      "phone": "0123456789",
      "address1": "Unit 2, 5 Yileen Court",
      "address2": null,
      "suburb": "ASHWOOD",
      "state": "VIC",
      "postcode": "3147",
      "isBusiness": false
    },
    "destination": {
      "firstName": "Boomerang",
      "lastName": "Returns",
      "companyName": "CouriersPlease",
      "email": "unknown@couriersplease.com.au",
      "phone": "1300 361 000",
      "deliveryChoiceID": "728",
      "isBusiness": true
    }
  }
}
```


Sample Response (401 - Unauthorized)


```
{
"responseCode": "UNAUTHORIZED",
"msg": "Not a valid token.",
"data": ""
}
```


(Note: An invalid API key was used)

Sample Response (400 – Bad Request)


```
{
  "responseCode": "Invalid input",
  "msg": "Data Validation Error",
  "data": {
    "errors": [
      {
        "type": "Required Field",
        "field": "pickup.postcode",
        "description": "Please enter pickup postcode."
      }
    ]
  }
}
```


(Note: The postcode for the pickup address was missing)

Sample Response (500 – Error)


```
{
  "responseCode": "500",
  "msg": "Internal Server Error",
  "data": null
}
```


(Note: API was offline)

Trouble Shooting

This section highlights the possible causes of API errors and possible solutions for them.

Further assistance can be obtained by sending an email to the below addresses:

Email apisupport@couriersplease.com.au or connect@couriersplease.com.au

Possible causes of errors.

Below is a table of errors and possible causes. The following page has a list of possible solutions.

Error Code	Value	Possible Causes
400	Bad Request	Missing postcode/ suburb or other required fields. Incorrect Rate Card ID. Decimal places in Integer fields Example: "width": "3.00",
401	Unauthorised	Using Test credentials in Production environment. Using Production credentials in Test environment. Incorrect Account Number or API Key. Incorrect Authentication Type.
403	Forbidden	Invalid character (example: /) in request. Incomplete request. Incorrect request structure. Requesting Server Address may be blocked
404	Not found	This error is unlikely when using the Shipment Create API
408	Request Timeout	API is not responding (various reasons). Too many requests being passed at the same time.
500	Internal Server Error	Server may be offline

Possible Solutions to Errors

The table below contains to most common solutions to API errors.

Error Code	Value	Possible Solutions
400	Bad Request	Check request for errors such as empty fields and decimal points. Check the date and time is current and in the correct format.
401	Unauthorised	Check the credentials being used are correct Contact Couriers Please to confirm credentials
403	Forbidden	Check request for errors such as invalid characters. Check hosting server is not in a blacklisted country.
404	Not found	Check with Couriers Please API Support
408	Request Timeout	Test using a single request to see if API is online Check with Couriers Please API Support.
500	Internal Server Error	Check API parameters are correct. Check availability of service with Couriers Please